

Cristi Prodan

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with experience designing and building cloud-based systems, microservices, and API platforms. Focused on reliability, scalability, and delivering production-ready software. Experienced across the stack, from DevOps to frontend, with particular strength in backend engineering. Recently developed an MVP end-to-end and enjoy working autonomously while collaborating with cross-functional teams.

Experience

Independent contractor (Remote EU - Romania)

Jan 2025 - Feb 2026

- Transitioned into independent contracting to explore diverse projects and clients.
- Founded and bootstrapped an e-commerce platform MVP that enables entrepreneurs to create and manage online stores; launched at comerz.ro.
- multitenant, Rails, Postgresql.
- Enjoyed generative AI capabilities: codex, conductor, linear.

Senior Software Engineer, Zerofy (Remote EU - Romania)

Jan 2024 - Feb 2025

- Built serverless event-driven workflows with Google Cloud Functions (lambda), Firebase, Node.js (cloud-native on GCP) to support the mobile frontend (Zerofy App LIVE).
- Integrated external vendor APIs, including reverse-engineered interfaces when documentation was unavailable.
- Reduced technical debt through targeted refactors and cleanup.

Senior Software Engineer, PTC Schweiz (Zürich and Remote EU - Romania) Oct 2015 - Jan 2024

- Built, owned and operated Vuforia Cloud microservices (Scala, Akka) for manufacturing Augmented Reality products LIVE on AWS.
- Collaborated strongly with Machine Learning engineering Team to integrate models into production APIs and containerized services; collaborated with testing and support teams.
- Implemented end-to-end automated tests in Scala to strengthen the reliability of REST APIs reducing on-call incidents.
- Developed CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and TeamCity.
- Delivered major refactors and contributed to internal deployment tooling.
- Led initiatives to develop internal tools that improved developer productivity across multiple teams.
- Integrated static analysis tools like Veracode and Snyk into the development workflow to enhance code security and quality.

- Implemented security best practices across services after completing multiple security training programs throughout the years (owasp, remote).
- Implemented Single Sign On auth with Amazon Cognito.
- Contributed to monitoring and observability initiatives (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana).
- Authored API documentation using OpenAPI v3.
- Implemented WebSocket (proxy) service for real-time collaboration services app (remote assistance, Chalk).
- Conducted technical interviews and contributed to engineering hiring decisions.

Senior Engineer, Qualcomm (Zürich, Switzerland)

Jan 2014 - Oct 2015

- Expanded cloud services with Scala and Play on AWS.
- Automated operations and built internal tools tasks using Python and Bash.
- Ported services to Docker and maintained legacy Ruby on Rails systems.
- Designed and built an internal Ruby DSL for testing APIs across multiple teams, collaborating closely with those teams.
- Participated in scaling infrastructure from a few to hundreds of EC2 instances on AWS (S3, SQS, DynamoDB, Cognito, Autoscaling).

Software Engineer, Kooaba (Zürich, Switzerland)

Feb 2011 - Jan 2014

- Initiated and led the move from a monolith to Scala-based microservices, increased scalability and reduced memory usage.
- Built REST APIs and a web backend using Ruby on Rails.
- Rewrote and maintained an Android application.
- Performed MySQL optimizations/ updates on live databases with 30m+ rows.

Head of Technology, Alliants (Cluj-Napoca, Romania)

Sep 2008 - Feb 2011

- Hired and led a small team of 3 engineers delivering Ruby on Rails apps for different customers.
- Coordinated on-site delivery in London.

Skills

- Languages: Ruby, Python, Scala, JavaScript, Bash
- Frameworks and Libraries: Rails, Akka, Play, Node.js
- Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, GCP, Docker, REST APIs, OAuth2, JWT, SSO
- Data and Search: MySQL, Elasticsearch, Kibana
- Testing and Tooling: GitHub Actions, TeamCity, LaTeX, Open API, linux, awk, sed

Education

- Master's Degree, Computer Science — Babes-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca (2008–2010). Thesis: Recommender Systems using Collaborative Filtering (<https://github.com/christian/Rho-article>).
- Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science — Alexandru Ioan Cuza University, Iasi (2005–2008). Thesis: Mobile Recommender System.
- Machine learning course, with Andrew Ng.
- Back in 2011, before Coursera was invented.

Languages

English (fluent), Romanian (fluent), German (basic), French (basic)

Fun projects

- I love music. Since 2013 I'm building and evolving a Virtual Private Organ (musical instrument). Here's the initial story: hauptwerk/virtual-private-organ.html. Some Arduino programming on my github: <https://github.com/christian/virtual-private-organ/tree/master/ArduinoCombinationPistons>.
- In 2025, I conducted a small Christmas concerto with our small choir and orchestra.
- I'm a big fan of LilyPond for engraving sheet music: <https://lilypond.org/>.
- Bootstrapped and maintained e-commerce solution featuring various API integrations LIVE since 2012: <https://www.perlasuferintei.ro/>.